title: O-Rings description: The Slocum hull and component O-rings: G2 single-seal vs G3 double-seal part numbers and sizes, the full spares kit, approved lubricants (Parker O-Lube vs Molykote and the community debate), inspection and replacement, sealing-surface scratches and the sanding controversy, lubricant dry-out, vacuum loss, and assembly tips.

O-Rings

O-rings are the glider's primary defense against flooding. Every hull joint, plug, and through-hull fitting relies on a correctly sized, clean, lightly lubricated O-ring seated in an undamaged groove against an undamaged sealing surface. Most Slocum leaks are **not** main-hull O-ring failures — they're bulkhead connectors, instrument seals installed with the wrong O-ring, or loose through-hull fittings — but the main-hull O-rings are what you inspect and replace most often, so getting their part numbers, lubricant, and handling right is foundational.

Source

Paraphrased from the *Slocum G3 Glider Maintenance Manual* (Rev. A, "O-ring Maintenance", "Main Hull Double O-ring Seals", "Main Hull O-Rings"), the *Slocum Glider Operators Manual*, the Teledyne Webb Research user forum, and the UG2 community Slack. Part numbers and prices change — always confirm the current part numbers with `glidersupport@teledyne.com` and defer to the official Teledyne documentation for your specific glider.

Single seal (G2) vs. double seal (G3)

A defining hardware difference between the platforms: